

What your clubs actually do

Fourteen rounds, 979 tracked shots, every one with a start and end GPS fix. Because each hole ends with a holed putt, the cup position is known exactly — so every shot can be measured not just for length, but for how far it finished from where you aimed.

24 May – 15 Aug 2026 198 holes • 3 courses 979 shots

193 m Driver stock distance, total	63 % Approaches played with a club that cannot reach the pin	19 % Greens in regulation	+1.24 Strokes over par per hole
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THE HEADLINE

You are not missing left or right. You are missing short.

Across every approach distance band, your sideways error is small — the average shot finishes within 6 m of the target line. That is genuinely good aim. The distance axis tells a completely different story: between 52% and 90% of approaches finish short of the hole, and the shortfall grows the further out you are.

APPROACH SHOTS – 267 ATTEMPTS FROM 30–200 M, TEE SHOTS ON PAR 4S AND 5S EXCLUDED

DISTANCE TO PIN	SHOTS	HIT GREEN	MEDIAN FINISH FROM PIN	MEDIAN DISTANCE ERROR	FINISHED SHORT	SIDEWAYS ERROR
30–60 m	50	62%	10.2 m	0.0 m	52%	–1.6 m
60–90 m	41	42%	13.1 m	–9.0 m	66%	–1.8 m
90–120 m	61	30%	14.8 m	–4.9 m	74%	+1.2 m
120–150 m	52	21%	17.9 m	–7.1 m	69%	–4.7 m
150–200 m	63	11%	32.2 m	–28.5 m	90%	+1.3 m

From 150–200 m the median approach finishes **28 m short** — not off line, just nowhere near the green. Nine out of ten of those shots come up short.

The cause is partly strike and partly arithmetic. Sixty-three percent of your approaches are played with a club whose own stock distance is **less than the distance you are facing** — the shot cannot finish pin-high even if you flush it. When you are more than 20 m under-clubbed, your green-hit rate collapses from roughly a third to 4%.

GREEN-HIT RATE BY HOW MUCH CLUB YOU ACTUALLY HAD

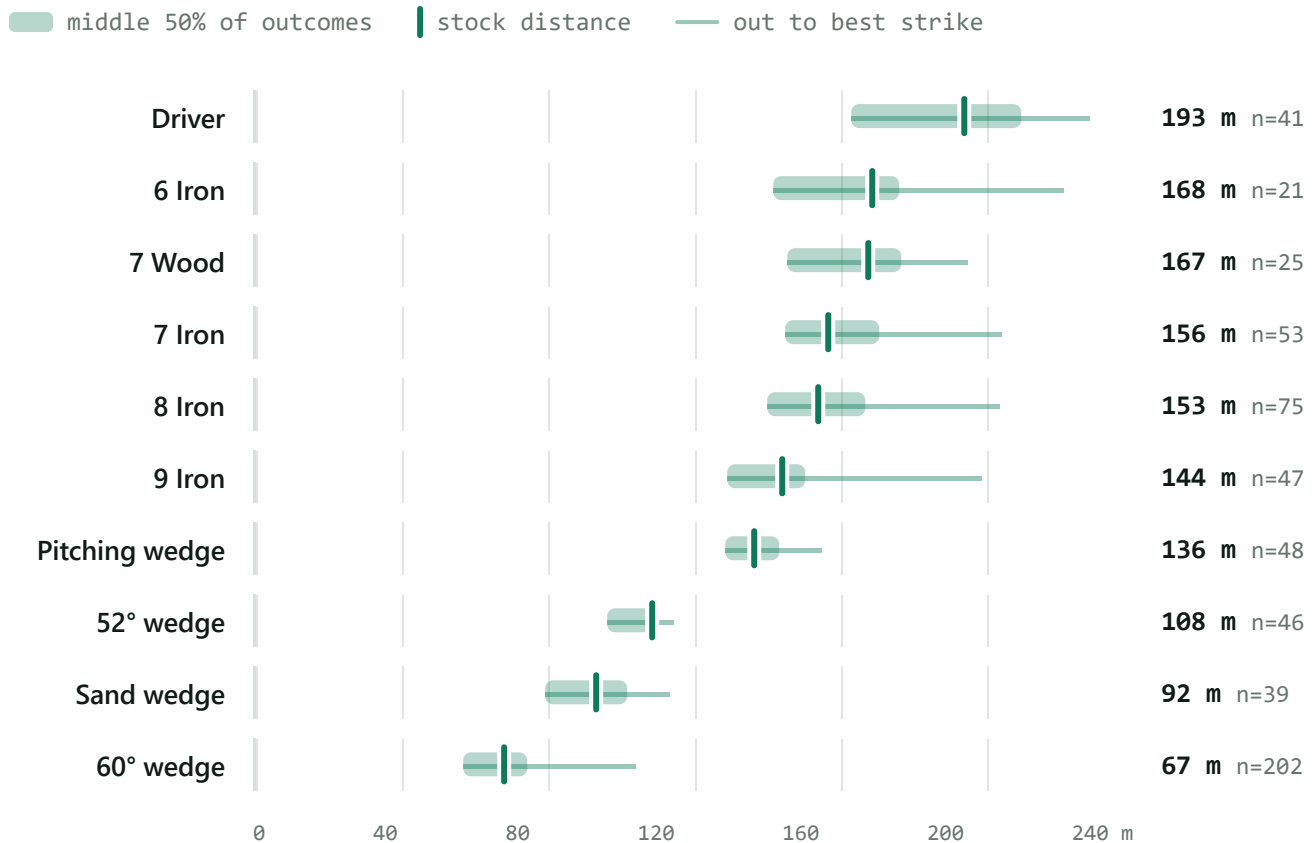
CLUB VS. DISTANCE FACED	SHOTS	HIT GREEN	MEDIAN FINISH FROM PIN
20 m+ short of club	46	4%	45.1 m
10–20 m short	47	32%	16.9 m
0–10 m short	56	32%	15.0 m
Just enough (0–10 m spare)	50	28%	13.7 m
Comfortably enough (10 m+)	39	33%	15.6 m

Note what this does **not** say: taking one extra club everywhere is not the fix — the middle four rows are all much the same. The damage is concentrated in the **46 shots played 20 m or more beyond the club's reach**. Eliminating only those is the single cheapest stroke saving available to you.

THE BAG

Stock yardages

Every distance below is **total** — carry plus roll — measured GPS point to GPS point, in metres. "Stock" is the median of full-swing attempts with the mishits removed; the bar shows the middle half of your outcomes and the thin line runs out to your best strike with that club.



Full-swing shots only: a shot counts as a full swing when the pin was further away than that club's own 75th-percentile distance, so partial and finesse shots are excluded. Mishits — anything under 70% of stock — are excluded from the stock figure but counted in the reliability table below.

Three holes in the ladder, and a four-club traffic jam

Your 6 iron, 7 wood, 7 iron and 8 iron all finish within 15 m of each other (168 / 167 / 156 / 153 m). That is four clubs doing one club's job. Meanwhile there are three genuine holes in the set, and the 108–136 m hole sits exactly in the distance band where you face the most approach shots.

28 m

Between the 52° wedge (108 m) and the pitching wedge (136 m) — your most-used scoring range, uncovered.

25 m

Between the driver (193 m) and the 6 iron (168 m). Nothing to hit from a fairway at 180 m.

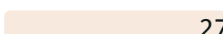
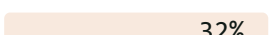
25 m

Between the sand wedge (92 m) and the 60° (67 m) — the awkward three-quarter zone.

Which clubs you can trust under pressure

A mishit here is a full swing that travelled less than 70% of that club's stock distance — a top, a chunk, a shot that leaves you effectively where you started. The spread column is the standard deviation of your good strikes as a percentage of stock: lower means the club does the same thing every time.

FULL-SWING RELIABILITY, ALL 14 ROUNDS

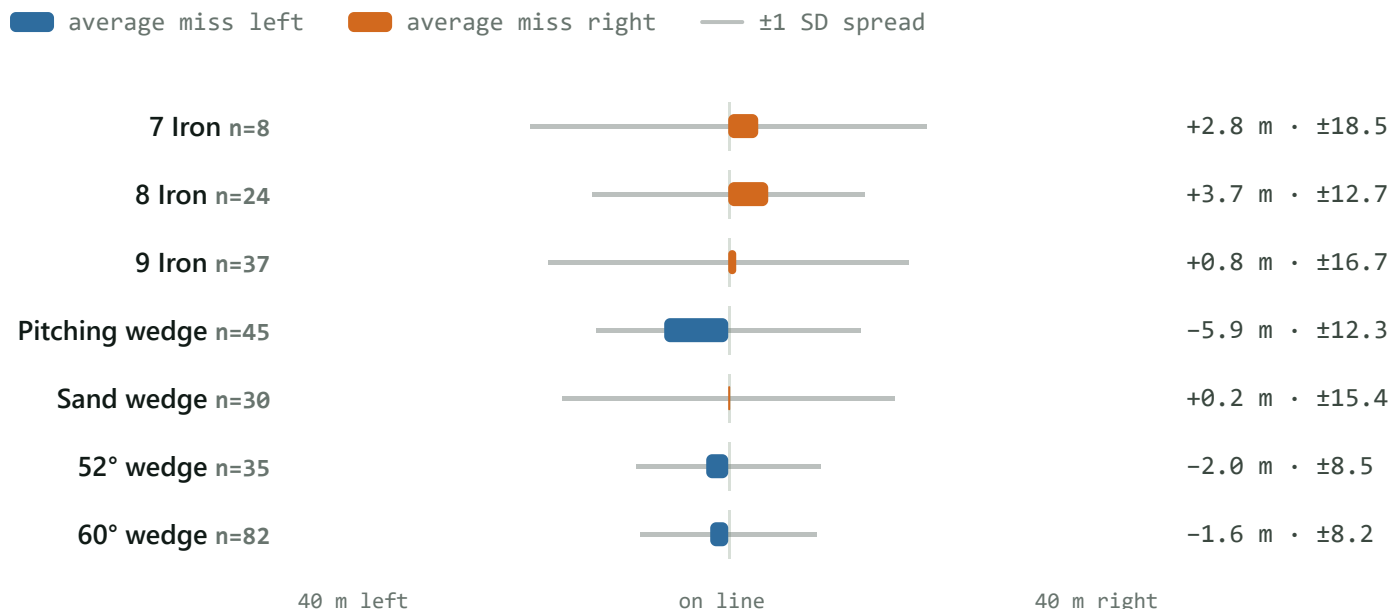
CLUB	FULL SWINGS	MISHIT RATE	DISTANCE SPREAD	BALLS LOST
52° wedge	19 	5%	±10.5%	0
6 Iron	21 	5%	±14.8%	0
Sand wedge	22 	9%	±16.4%	1
9 Iron	28 	11%	±11.6%	1
60° wedge	66 	15%	±20.6%	0
7 Iron	50 	16%	±13.3%	1
Pitching wedge	24 	17%	±10.7%	0
8 Iron	65 	20%	±13.9%	0
Driver	41 	27%	±14.8%	5
7 Wood	25 	32%	±13.3%	2

Your 6 iron and 52° wedge are the two most reliable clubs in the bag — a 5% mishit rate each and not a single ball lost between them. The 6 iron has been in your hands just 21 times in 14 rounds, against 75 swings with the far less reliable 8 iron. The 7 wood is the least reliable club you own: one swing in three is a mishit, for a distance the 6 iron already covers.

MISS PATTERN

Where the ball finishes, side to side

Measured against the true line to the cup on approach shots. The bar is your **average** miss — which way you lean — and the grey whisker behind it is one standard deviation, the spread you should actually plan for.



Scale runs ± 40 m. No club shows a bias worth aiming off for — every average sits inside 6 m of the target line, well within the spread. Your aim is not the problem.

OFF THE TEE

Keep the driver. Fix where it starts.

The driver looks alarming in isolation: **14% of tee shots lost**, a 27% mishit rate, and a directional spread of $\pm 26^\circ$ against your own typical line on that hole — three to five times wider than any iron. The obvious conclusion is to leave it in the bag. The data does not support that conclusion.

On the eight holes where you have hit **both** a wood and an iron off the tee, the wood wins:

SAME 8 HOLES, 68 TEE SHOTS — DRIVER/WOOD VS. IRON

	TEE SHOTS	AVERAGE DISTANCE	FAIRWAY	LOST OR BUNKERED	LEFT TO THE PIN	SCORE ON THE HOLE
Driver / 7 wood	44	145.8 m	25%	11.4%	216 m	+1.52
Iron	24	136.5 m	29%	12.5%	256 m	+2.17

Laying back with an iron has not been safer — the trouble rate is the same (12.5% vs 11.4%) — and it leaves you **40 m further from the hole**, which costs about **0.65 shots per hole**.

The real driver problem is not distance or even dispersion, it is the total misses. Of the ten lost balls that can be traced to a specific shot, **nine were tee shots** — five

of them with driver. And a hole with a penalty on it averages **+3.05 over par** against **+1.04** without one.

TEE SHOTS ON PAR 4S AND 5S, BY CLUB

CLUB	TEE SHOTS	MEDIAN DISTANCE	FAIRWAY	ROUGH	LOST	SPREAD VS OWN LINE
Driver	35	170.5 m	23%	63%	14.3%	±26.3°
6 Iron	12	152.3 m	33%	58%	0%	±5.0°
7 Iron	26	152.0 m	31%	62%	3.8%	±7.4°
8 Iron	29	150.1 m	38%	62%	0%	±6.1°
7 Wood	12	139.2 m	25%	67%	8.3%	±8.1°

Note the 6 iron: it goes **within 18 m of your driver's median tee shot**, finds the fairway more often, has never lost you a ball, and is five times straighter. That is your bail-out club on any hole where the driver brings water or out-of-bounds into play — not the 7 wood, which loses balls at 8% and goes 30 m shorter.

SHORT GAME & PUTTING

Inside 30 metres you are good. On the green you are leaking.

This is the strong half of your game and it is worth knowing before you tee off: from inside 30 m you get the ball onto the green **90% of the time**, median leave 3.3 m. From a greenside bunker it is a different story — but only when you reach for the wrong club.

SHORT GAME INSIDE 30 M – 126 SHOTS

FROM	SHOTS	ONTO THE GREEN	MEDIAN LEAVE
Fairway	47	94%	3.7 m
Rough	54	93%	5.2 m
Fringe / green	12	92%	2.7 m
Bunker	13	62%	6.1 m

From sand, the 60° wedge gets you out onto the green **57%** of the time and leaves 3.5 m. All five bunker shots you have played with any other club failed to reach the green. In the sand, it is the 60° or nothing.

PUTTING – 360 PUTTS OVER 197 HOLES, 1.83 PER HOLE

DISTANCE	PUTTS	HOLED
Inside 1 m	103	88%
1–2 m	69	58% the leak
2–3 m	30	63%
3–5 m	56	43%
5–10 m	52	35%
10 m+	37	14%

Two things stand out. You hole **58% from 1–2 m** but 63% from 2–3 m — the short one is the one you are losing, which is a commitment problem, not a stroke problem. And your first putt from beyond 10 m finishes an average of **3.7 m away** — leaving a putt you hole only 44% of the time. That combination produces a three-putt on **11% of holes**.

WHERE THE STROKES GO

The arithmetic of a round

You hit **19% of greens in regulation**. On the holes where you do, you play them in level par. On the holes where you don't, you average a stroke and a half over. Nothing else in this report is worth as much as that gap.

AVERAGE SCORE AGAINST PAR, BY WHETHER THE GREEN WAS HIT IN REGULATION

	GREEN HIT IN REGULATION	GREEN MISSED	DIFFERENCE
Par 3 82 holes	-0.05	+1.07	1.12
Par 4 92 holes	+0.36	+1.73	1.37
Par 5 24 holes	+0.33	+1.90	1.57

1.9

Penalty strokes per 18 holes.
Nine of the ten traceable lost balls were tee shots.

2.0

Strokes per 18 holes given away to three-putts.

4.3 %

Green-hit rate on the 46 approaches played 20 m+ beyond the club's reach.

Five decisions to make before you tee off

1

Play the number, then add the club you actually own

Your ladder: 180–208 m driver · 167–180 6 iron · 154–167 7 iron · 148–154 8 iron · 140–148 9 iron · 122–140 pitching wedge · 100–122 52° · 80–100 sand wedge · under 80 60°. If the yardage sits more than 20 m above the club in your hand, it is the wrong club — take the next one up or take the layup deliberately.

2

Driver stays in play — the 6 iron is the bail-out

Keep hitting driver on anything wide. Where there is water or out-of-bounds in range, go to the 6 iron, not the 7 wood: it gives up only 18 m off the median driver, finds more fairways, has a $\pm 5^\circ$ dispersion, and has never cost you a ball. Leave the 7 wood in the bag entirely — the 6 iron covers its distance and it mishits one swing in three.

3

Treat every 1–2 m putt as the one that matters

You are holing 58% of them — worse than your 2–3 m rate. Two strokes a round are sitting there. Pair it with lag work: your first putt from beyond 10 m averages 3.7 m from the hole, which manufactures the exact putt you keep missing.

4

60° is the only club that goes in the sand

57% out and onto the green with the 60°; zero from five with anything else. No exceptions, whatever the lie looks like.

5

Aim at the middle of the green, not the flag

Your sideways error is small but your spread is ± 8 to ± 18 m depending on club, and you finish short far more often than long. Middle of the green, one club more than feels right, and let the short game — which is the best part of your bag — handle the rest.

How this was measured, and what to distrust

- **Distances are total, not carry** — GPS start point to GPS end point, in metres. On a soft course in the morning your effective numbers will be shorter than this table.
- **Par is inferred, not read from a scorecard.** Holes under 210 m are treated as par 3, under 400 m as par 4, longer as par 5. Witbos in particular looks like a short layout with many par 3s, so the "over par" figures there carry more uncertainty than the two championship rounds.
- **The cup position is exact.** Every hole ends with a holed putt, so the final shot's end coordinate is the cup — that is what makes the short/long and left/right measurements possible rather than estimated.
- **The driver-versus-iron comparison is observational.** You chose which club to hit, so some of the iron's worse scoring may reflect the situations that prompted an iron rather than the club itself. It is enough to say the data gives no support for benching the driver — not enough to prove the driver causes lower scores.
- **Penalty attribution is partial.** 21 penalty strokes across 19 holes; only 10 have a traceable culprit shot in the data. The 5 driver / 2 wood split is indicative, not complete.
- **Small samples are flagged in the tables.** The 7 iron dispersion row (n=8), the 6 iron tee row (n=12) and all par-5 splits (n=24) are directional only. The 5 iron appears once in 979 shots and has been left out.